A-A-51218B
31 August 1987
SUPERSEDING
A-A-51218A
16 June 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TEST PACK, AIR REMOVAL, STEAM STERILIZER

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers a once-a-day, single-use, disposable, Bowie & Dick type box of 30 air removal test packs. This substitutes for the hand-assembled Bowie & Dick type towel packs.

Salient characteristic:

The test pack shall be disposable and ready-to-use in testing the efficacy of the vacuum system in prevacuum high-temperature sterilizers.

The test pack shall be capable of detecting defiencies in a sterilizer's ability to generate vacuums with air removal and maintaining vacuums without air leaking back into the chamber.

The test pack shall be capable of obtaining results comparable to that obtained by the use of the hand-assembled Bowie-Dick type towel pack as described by the Association for the advancement of Medical Instrumentation (AAMI) "Good Hospital Practice: Steam Sterilization and Sterility Assurance". The indicator sheets from the disposable test packs shall show comparable sensitivity to air abbreviated cycle times, reduced vaccumms, and leaks as the sheets removed from hand-assembled test packs. The results shall be confirmed by laboratory tests on sterilizers modified to permit variable control of cycle times, vacuums and leaks generated. Results are considered valid when taken from at least ten cycles for each set of conditions for either type of pack (for a total of 20 cycles per single condition).

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

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These procedures are in agreement with the protocol of the "AAMI, Recommended Practice for Steam Sterilization and Sterility Assurance". (The above referenced documents are available from the Association for the Advancement of Medical Instrumentation, Suite 417, 1500 Wilson Blvd., Arlington, VA 22209).

This item is intended to replace the Bowie-Dick hand-assembled test pack. Therefore, any device that effectively mimics the Bowie-Dick test pack is acceptable provided the dimensions of 9 inches (22.9 cm) by 12 inches (30.5 cm) by 2 inches (51.cm) per test and total exterior shipping container weight per unit of issue of 34 pounds are not exceeded.

Instructions.

An instruction sheet shall be included in each box of 30 packs.

Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first quality throughout. Sheets shall be free from performance and cosmetic defects.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing 30 test packs and instructions, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contact or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following Nation Stock Number is covered by this document:

6530-01-242-5389

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior quantities, labeling, and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order.

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A-A-51218B

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 54025

Project No. 6530-1943

Location: CID/TEST/H1B-3

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions - Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51218B	Test Pack, Air Removal, Steam Sterilizer

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* - Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* - Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* - Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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